



TRUSTMRR DATASET DEEP-DIVE

From 1,000 Startups to a Brand Thesis

How the data pointed toward automation — and toward tutoring as where my own experience meets the opportunity



THE OBJECTIVE

What is this data, and what am I looking for?

I want to identify a vertical worth building an automation-focused brand in — grounded in real revenue data, not gut feel.

1,000

Startup listings
on TrustMRR

29

Data points per
startup

\$76.6M

Highest all-time
revenue in the set

65

Countries
represented

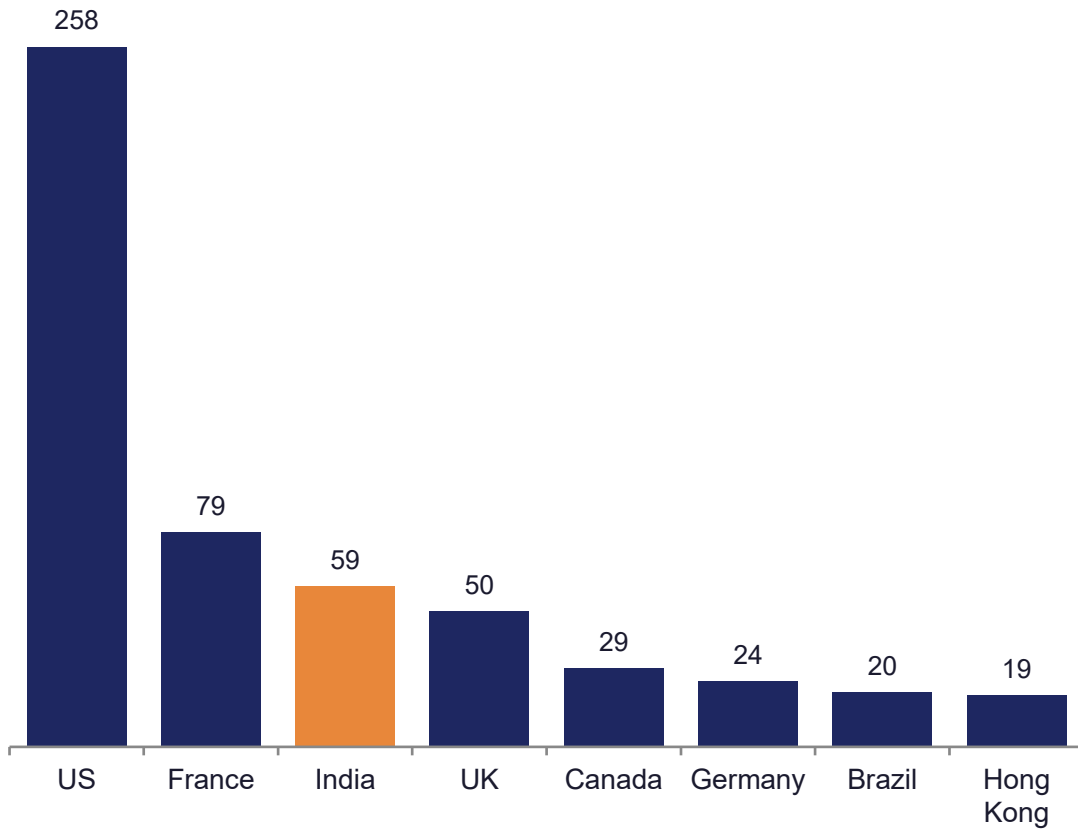
TrustMRR is a marketplace where founders list their startups for sale — each listing carries verified revenue, MRR, traffic, pricing, and buyer-facing positioning data. That makes it a rare window into what small, real, revenue-generating internet businesses actually look like today.



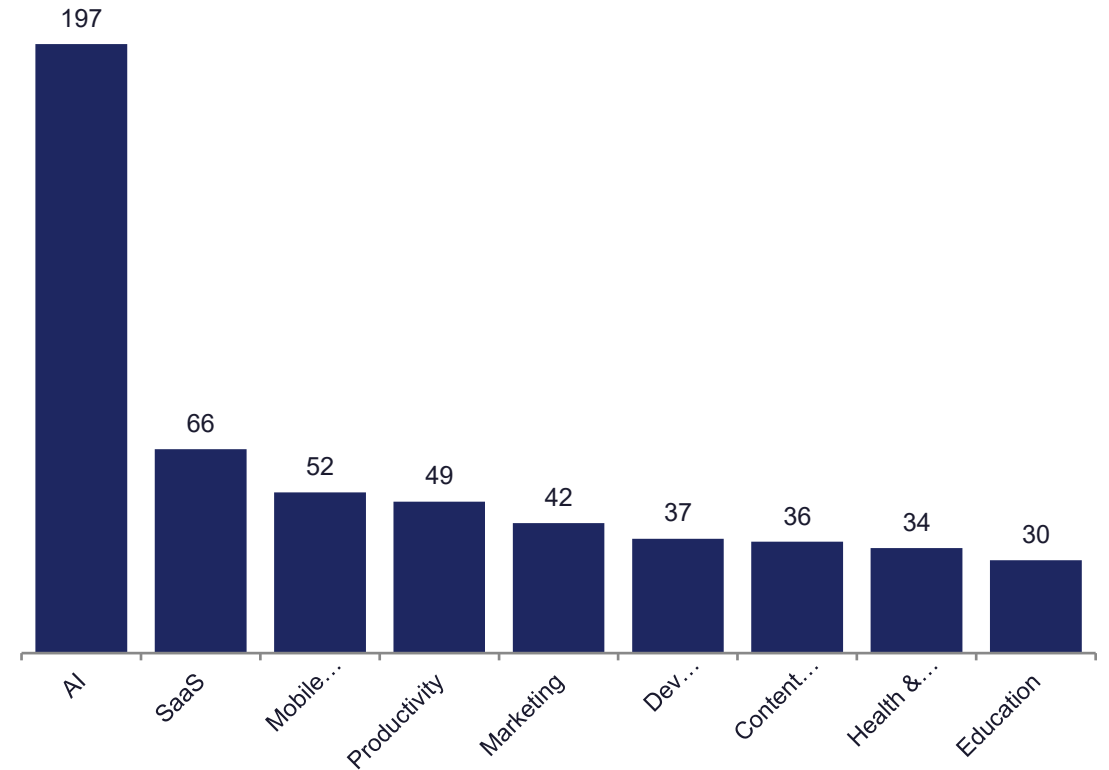
STEP 1 · FIRST CUT ACROSS ALL 1,000

The Landscape

Startups by Country (top 8 of 65)



Startups by Category (top 9 of 29)



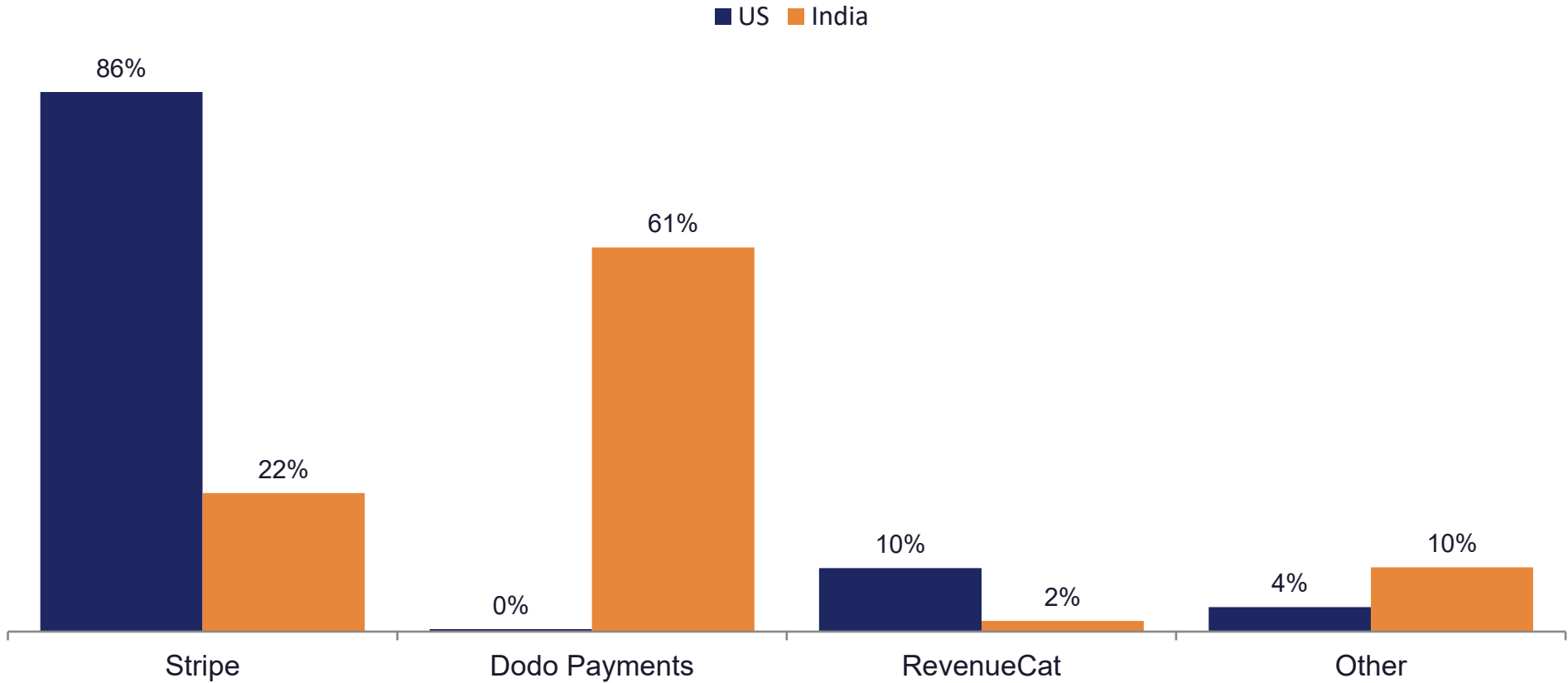
27% of listings (274) carry no category tag at all.



STEP 1 · FIRST CUT ACROSS ALL 1,000

A Curious Clue

Same categories, same marketplace — but a completely different payment stack shows up in one country.



Why would India lean so heavily on a provider almost nobody else uses?

What This Told Us



Dodo Payments is built for local GST compliance and emerging-market payment rails. Stripe still leads everywhere else — including the US, at 86% — but in India it drops to 22%, overtaken by a provider almost nobody else on the platform uses.

That's not noise. It's a sign that India might behave like a genuinely different market — worth a dedicated look, not just a footnote in the global numbers.

So that's exactly what we did next.



So We Went Looking for India, Specifically

India is the market I ultimately want to build for. With a first signal already in hand, the natural next step was a dedicated cut of the data: country-wise, provider-wise, category-wise, revenue-wise.

59

Indian startups
in the dataset (5.9%)

4

Payment providers
India relies on

4

Revenue windows to
compare vs. US & Total

Question on the table: does India's revenue picture support building here first?



The India Reality Check

Average & median revenue per startup — Total vs. US vs. India

Revenue Window	Total Avg / Median	US Avg / Median	India Avg / Median
Last 30 Days	\$15,596 / \$400	\$38,152 / \$1,396	\$2,389 / \$24
Last 3 Months	\$32,400 / \$944	\$66,137 / \$3,166	\$5,281 / \$31
Last 12 Months	\$133,750 / \$3,068	\$329,560 / \$12,292	\$19,823 / \$98

So — does this justify building India-first, right now, or not?



Not Yet

India's median revenue runs 60–125x below the US's across every window, and average revenue is still 13–17x lower. Combined with a sample of just 59 startups — 14 of them at literally \$0 in the last year — **there isn't enough signal yet to build a standalone India analysis.**

Decision: set India aside for now — not ruled out, just not enough data yet — and go find out what the highest, most consistent earners in the full dataset actually look like.

We'll come back to India within that lens.



STEP 3 · THE PIVOT

Chasing the Real Earners

Instead of one market, widen the lens to the whole dataset: which startups are earning the most, most consistently?

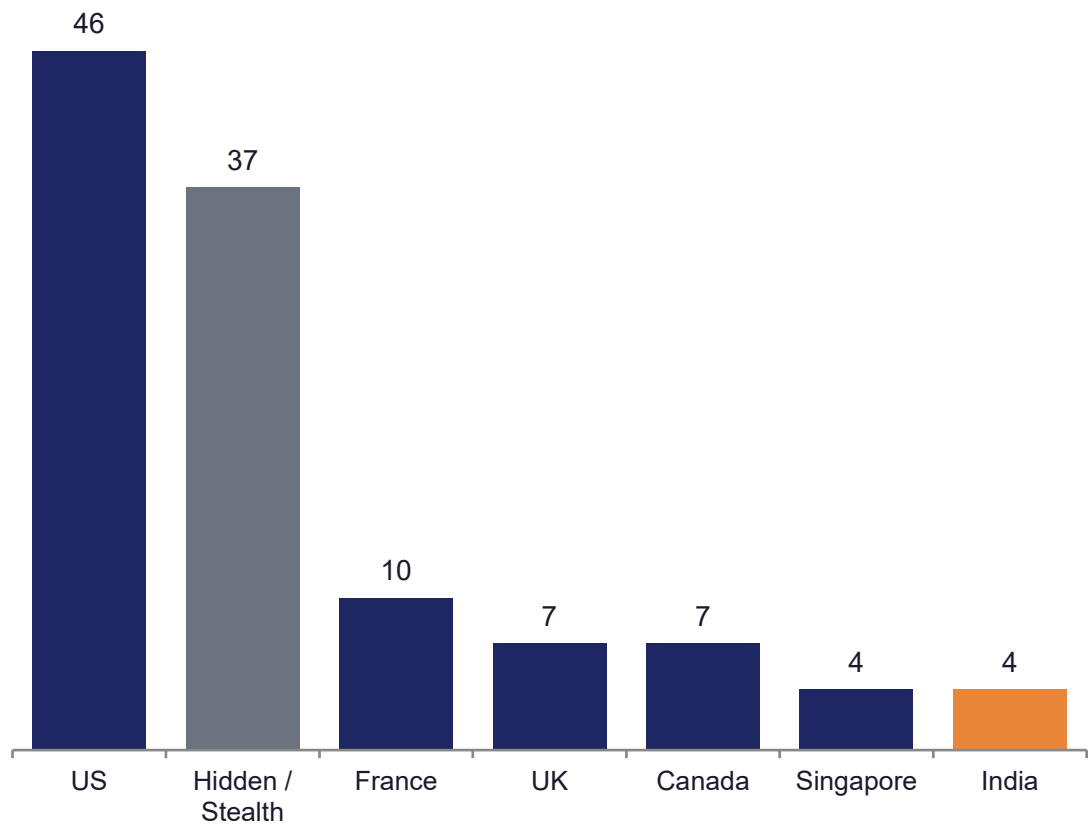


This is the shortlist we now dig into — category by category.

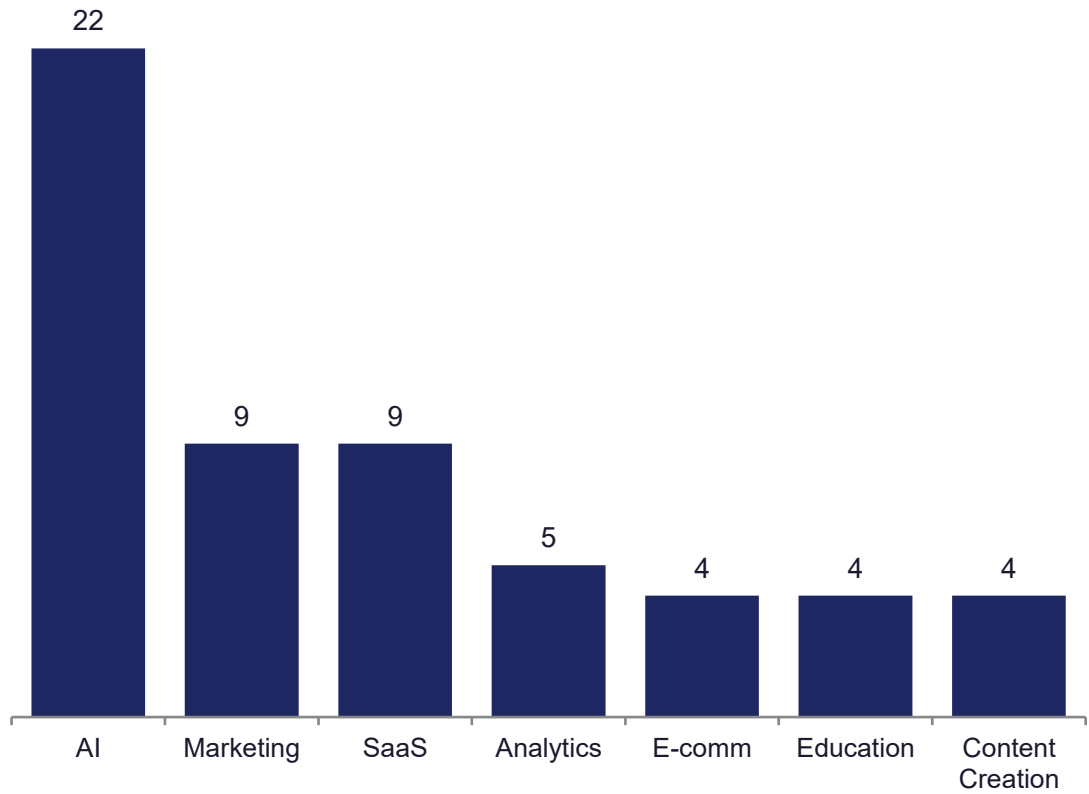


Who Makes the Cut

By country (top 7)



By category (top 7 of 22 tagged)



Remember India's payment-rails clue? Let's check back in.



STEP 3 · CIRCLING BACK TO INDIA

Only 4 of India's 59 Startups Clear This Bar

7%

of India's startups
reach the top-earner tier

18%

of US startups
reach the same tier

Small sample, and a lower hit-rate too — this is the same story the revenue table already told us, from a different angle.



Category X-Ray: The Software & Service Plays



AI

22 startups

What: Automates knowledge work — SEO, prospecting, writing, tutoring

Pricing: \$13–\$99/mo tiered, often a free tier

Persona: Split B2B / B2C



Marketing

9 startups

What: SEO, backlinks & lead-gen — agency-style service, not pure software

Pricing: \$250–\$4,000/mo retainers

Persona: B2B — agencies & local trades



SaaS

9 startups

What: Vertical workflow tools — scheduling, client mgmt, fraud checks

Pricing: 3-tier monthly, \$19–\$400/mo

Persona: B2B — service professionals



Category X-Ray: The Commerce & Skill-Building Plays



E-comm

4 startups

What: Private-label, dropshipping, ticket resale, WhatsApp commerce

Pricing: Flat monthly, \$49–\$200/mo

Persona: B2B entrepreneurs



Content Creation

4 startups

What: AI video / post / book generation, on autopilot

Pricing: \$39–\$199/mo tiered

Persona: B2C — creators, self-publishers



Education

4 startups

What: Coding, interview prep, writing-detection, presentations

Pricing: Low-cost, \$9.99–\$34/mo

Persona: B2C — students, career-switchers

★ MOST PERSONALLY RELEVANT



STEP 3 · WHERE INDIA SHOWS UP

The 4 Indian Startups in the Shortlist

One per category — cleared the top-earner bar

Education

\$215,480 /12mo

MagicSlides.app

Turns a prompt or document into a ready-to-use PPT in seconds

Pricing: \$29–\$34/mo

AI

\$206,255 /12mo

Kortex-Notebooklm

Bridges AI chats, web research & notes into one searchable base

Pricing: Free → \$3.75/mo

Dev Tools

\$205,788 /12mo

Web3Forms

Backend-free contact-form API for developers

Pricing: Free forever (capped)

Recruiting & HR

\$126,595 /12mo

Hirevire

One-way video interview screening for recruiters

Pricing: 7-day free trial

All four are low-cost, self-serve, prosumer-leaning tools — a different shape from the higher-ticket, agency-style plays that show up more often in the US cohort. Flagged for deeper India-specific research once a vertical is chosen.



STEP 4 · THE SYNTHESIS

The Golden Thread Running Through Every Category

AUTOMATION



AI

Automates knowledge work — writing, research, prospecting



Marketing

Automates lead-gen & SEO operations



SaaS

Automates scheduling & client operations



E-comm

Automates commerce ops — fulfillment, resale, WhatsApp



Content Creation

Automates content ops — video, posts, books



Education

Automates skill-building & practice loops

Every high-earning category is, underneath, a different flavor of the same bet: replace a repetitive task a human used to do with software that does it automatically.



THE PERSONAL FIT

Why Tutoring. Why Me.

*Content Automation is the strongest data signal.
Tutoring is where it meets real, lived experience.*



SAT Verbal Faculty

SATnPaper



Academic Manager & Verbal/Reasoning Faculty

Global Creed

The Market Case



SAT prep is a proven, high-value category

Test prep for the US market is one of the largest, most consistent tutoring niches globally — a large, willing-to-pay audience with a recurring, high-stakes need.



The shortlist already proves the model works

Rezi, Atlas, Codédex, DataExpert, and fastwrite.io — all education/tutoring-adjacent AI tools — cleared the top-earner bar on exactly this kind of content automation.



Real teaching credibility de-risks the hardest part

The biggest question for any tutoring product is whether the content is actually good. Direct classroom and test-prep experience answers that before a single line of code is written.

This is the throughline the rest of the conclusion builds on.



Where I'll Build

#1 · TOP PICK

Content Automation — Tutoring-Led

Writing, prospecting, resume-building — and, above all, SAT tutoring for the US market. The broadest revenue evidence in the shortlist (22 of 135) meets direct teaching experience — the strongest personal-fit case of any option here.

#2 · ON THE RADAR

B2B Lead Generation

Local-trades lead-gen and influencer/creator collaboration at scale. Higher ticket size (\$250–\$4,000/mo) stood out in the data — worth watching, but not a commitment right now.

#3 · ANOTHER OPTION

Vertical SaaS, For a New Niche

Scheduling, cold-email deliverability, and client management — the EliteTrainer model, generalized beyond personal trainers to a different profession.

Also reinforcing the same automation thread: private-label/dropshipping enablement, ticket resale automation, WhatsApp commerce automation, and content creation tools — folded into this lens rather than treated as standalone bets for now.

► **Next:** *validate the SAT-tutoring angle with real conversations in the US market. B2B lead-gen and vertical SaaS stay background options to watch. India gets revisited within whichever vertical launches first — set aside for thin data, not ruled out.*